10-09 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） Why Do We Dream?

① Almost every human being on Earth dreams every night — about four to six dreams, though we remember very few of them. Some dreams are lovely: you walk in a garden of moving flowers. Some are strange: your maths teacher is suddenly the captain of a spaceship. Some are frightening: you are running, but your feet will not move. **What are dreams, and why does the brain spend hours of every night making them?** Scientists do not have one final answer, but they have many interesting ones.

② First, a short word about the biology. Most dreaming happens during a stage of sleep called **REM sleep** — "REM" means **Rapid Eye Movement**. During REM, your eyes move quickly under closed lids, your heart beats faster, and your brain is almost as active as when you are awake. A healthy teenager has four or five REM periods per night. The longest one comes just before waking up, which is why you often remember your "morning dream" most clearly.

③ One popular theory says dreams are how the brain **sorts and stores the day's memories**. Imagine your day as a messy desk: the brain, at night, quietly opens each folder, decides what to keep, what to throw away, and what to put next to what. A student who has studied English words on Monday often dreams, a little, of those words — and wakes on Tuesday remembering the words better. Studies have shown that students who sleep after learning do better in tests than students who stay up late.

④ A second theory sees dreams as a kind of **emotional repair**. During the day we meet small stresses — an argument with a friend, a harsh word from a teacher, a fear about a coming test. In REM sleep, the chemical that normally carries stress signals is almost switched off. The brain replays the emotional moments in a safer, quieter version. You may dream of the friend or the teacher, but the feeling is softer. You wake up, and the sharp edge has gone. Dreams may be the brain's way of giving our feelings a good long wash.

⑤ A third and very interesting theory says dreams are **a safe rehearsal for real life**. When our ancestors lived in forests, they often dreamed of being chased by dangerous animals. Today we dream of being late for an exam, forgetting our speech, or standing in front of the class without shoes. In these dreams, the brain lets us practise difficult situations **without real danger**, so that when the real moment comes, we have, in a way, already been there.

⑥ Not all dreams come from inside the head. Dreams can also be **triggered by the body**. If your room is cold, you may dream of walking in snow; if your bladder is full, you may dream of looking for a bathroom; if the phone rings softly, the ringtone may enter the

dream as a distant bell. The sleeping brain is still listening, even when the eyes are closed.

⑦ Can we control our dreams? Some people train themselves in **"lucid dreaming"**, in which the dreamer knows that he is dreaming and can gently change the story. This takes weeks of practice and careful sleep notes. Most scientists agree that the easier way to have better dreams is simpler: sleep enough, keep the room dark, and do not stare at a screen right before bed — because the light of the screen confuses the brain's night system.

⑧ So tonight, when you close your eyes, remember: your brain is about to begin a long, free film. Your memory, your feelings and your imagination will all meet in the same dark room. You may not recall much in the morning, but the film was real — and, quietly, it was doing the important work of keeping you yourself.

注释： REM 快速眼动；rehearsal 排练；bladder 膀胱；ancestor 祖先；lucid dreaming 清醒梦

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. When does most dreaming happen, according to the article?

A. During the deepest, quietest sleep.
B. During a stage called REM sleep, when the eyes move quickly and the brain is almost as active as when awake.
C. Only during the first few minutes after falling asleep.
D. Only during naps in the afternoon.

2. Why do students who sleep after learning often do better in tests?

A. Because sleep makes the test paper easier.
B. Because during sleep and dreaming the brain sorts and stores the day's memories, helping us remember what we learned.
C. Because sleeping students are luckier.
D. Because teachers give more points to sleepy students.

3. According to the "emotional repair" theory (Paragraph 4), what happens to our feelings during dreams?

A. The brain replays emotional moments in a softer, safer version, helping to soften sharp feelings by morning.
B. The brain multiplies every sad feeling ten times.
C. Feelings are deleted forever.
D. Feelings become strong enough to wake us up.

4. Which of the following is an example of a dream being triggered by the body?

A. Dreaming of yellow flowers for no reason.
B. Dreaming of walking in snow because the bedroom is cold.
C. Dreaming of a bus because you rode a bus three years ago.
D. Dreaming of happy music because you smiled yesterday.

5. What is the simplest way to have better dreams, according to the article?

A. Drink strong coffee before bed.
B. Sleep enough, keep the room dark, and avoid staring at a screen just before sleep.
C. Practise lucid dreaming every night.
D. Leave the bedroom light on all night.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "Most dreaming happens during a stage of sleep called REM sleep ... brain is almost as active as when you are awake."
【解析】REM 阶段大脑与清醒时几近活跃。A、C、D 均不符。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "dreams are how the brain sorts and stores the day's memories ... students who sleep after learning do better in tests"
【解析】睡眠帮助整理记忆。A、C、D 均荒谬。故选 B。

3.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "The brain replays the emotional moments in a safer, quieter version ... the sharp edge has gone."
【解析】情绪被温和回放，利于减压。B、C、D 均与原文相反或曲解。故选 A。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段 "If your room is cold, you may dream of walking in snow"
【解析】冷室→雪梦，正是身体触发。A、C、D 均非身体直接刺激。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B

【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑦段 "sleep enough, keep the room dark, and do not stare at a screen right before bed"
【解析】作者明确三条建议。A 咖啡反而干扰、C 难度高非"最简单"、D 违反原文。故选 B。